

Ultimate Level 10 Chocolate Chip Cookies

A gourmet, multi step chocolate chip cookie that uses browned butter, toasted flour, caramelized white chocolate, spelt flour, hazelnut coffee, and a three day chill for maximum flavor, texture, and visual appeal. The result is a crisp on the outside, fudgy inside cookie with complex toffee, coffee, and nutty notes.



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PREP: 72h 28m

COOK: 1h 43m

TOTAL: 83h 5m

SERVES: 12

COST: \$100.42

INGREDIENTS

113 g	Unsalted butter (80% fat, Challenge Dairy cubes) Note: Cut into cubes; used for brown butter	\$4.46
23 g	Ice water Note: Adds back moisture lost during browning	\$0.00
170 g	Allpurpose flour Note: Will be toasted with bread flour	\$3.72
90 g	Bread flour Note: Higher protein for chewiness; toasted with AP flour	\$7.87
50 g	Spelt flour Note: Adds nutty flavor; not toasted	\$11.00
1 tsp	Baking soda	\$7.82
2 tsp	Kosher salt Note: Divided – some in dough, some as finishing salt	\$3.82
1.5 tsp	Cornstarch Note: Helps create a tender crumb	\$2.03
1 tsp	Finely ground hazelnut coffee Note: Use whole roasted hazelnuts and espresso fine grind	\$6.59
200 g	Dark brown sugar Note: Packed; gives deep molasses flavor and less spread	\$2.33

175 g	Granulated white sugar Note: Helps with spread and crisp edges	\$3.07
2	Large eggs Note: Room temperature	\$0.40
1	Egg yolk Note: Extra yolk for richness	\$7.99
2 tsp	Vanilla paste Note: Twice the amount of extract for stronger flavor	\$14.99
142 g	Semisweet chocolate chips Note: One of three chocolate components	\$4.69
142 g	Dark chocolate (70% cacao) – chopped Note: Coarsely chopped for big pockets of chocolate	\$8.15
142 g	White chocolate (for caramelization) Note: Will be baked at low heat then chopped; creates caramelized shards	\$2.50
1 tsp	Flaky finishing salt Note: Sprinkled on baked cookies	\$8.99

INSTRUCTIONS

Toast the flour blend

30m

Preheat the oven to 350°F. Combine the allpurpose flour and bread flour (170g + 90g) on a rimmed baking sheet. Toss to spread evenly. Bake, stirring every 5minutes, for about 2530minutes until the flour turns a light golden hue and smells nutty. Remove and let cool completely before using.

Tips:

- Stirring prevents scorching.
- Cool the flour on a wire rack; warm flour will melt the butter later.

Brown the butter

10m

Place the 113g butter cubes in a small saucepan over medium heat. Swirl gently; when the butter foams and turns amber with browned milk solids, reduce heat to low. Add 23g ice water, whisk quickly, then remove from heat. Transfer to a shallow dish and refrigerate until solidified but still spreadable (about 810minutes).

Tips:

- Watch closely; burnt butter tastes bitter.
- Adding ice water stops the cooking and restores the original butter weight.

Caramelize white chocolate

45m

Line a baking sheet with parchment. Spread the 142g white chocolate in an even layer. Bake at 275°F for 45minutes, stirring every 15minutes. When the chocolate is deep caramel color and fragrant, remove and let cool. Pulse in a food processor until broken into coarse shards.

Tips:

- Do not let the chocolate melt completely; you want a caramelized, slightly crunchy texture.
- If shards are too soft, chill them 5minutes before processing.

Mix dry ingredients

5m

In a medium bowl whisk together the cooled toasted flour blend, spelt flour, baking soda, kosher salt, cornstarch, and finely ground hazelnut coffee until uniform.

Tips:

- Sifting the spelt flour prevents lumps.

Cream butter and sugars

5m

In the stand mixer bowl, beat the chilled brown butter with dark brown sugar and granulated sugar on medium speed until light and fluffy (about 5minutes).

Tips:

- Scrape down the sides of the bowl halfway through.

Add vanilla and eggs

3m

Add 2tsp vanilla paste, then beat in the two large eggs one at a time, followed by the extra yolk. Mix just until incorporated.

Tips:

- Do not over beat; you want a smooth emulsion.

Combine wet and dry

3m

Gradually add the dry ingredient mixture to the buttermilk mixture on low speed. Mix until just combined; a few streaks of flour are okay.

Tips:

- Over mixing develops gluten and makes cookies tough.

Fold in chocolates

2m

Using a spatula, fold in the semisweet chocolate chips, chopped dark chocolate, and caramelized white chocolate shards until evenly distributed.

Tips:

- Fold gently to keep the dough from becoming over worked.

Age the dough

72h

Cover the dough tightly with plastic wrap and refrigerate for at least 24hours, preferably 72hours, to allow flavors to develop and moisture to equilibrate.

Tips:

- If you're short on time, a minimum of 12hours still yields noticeable improvement.

Preheat and portion

5m

Preheat oven to 375°F. Line a baking sheet with parchment. Scoop the chilled dough with a 2tablespoon cookie scoop (or rounded tablespoon) onto the sheet, spacing 2inches apart.

Tips:

- Cold dough spreads less; you'll get a thicker cookie with defined edges.

Bake

13m

Bake for 1215minutes, rotating the sheet halfway through, until the edges are set and lightly golden while the centers still look soft.

Tips:

- Do not over bake; cookies continue to set on the sheet.

Cool

10m

Allow cookies to rest on the baking sheet for 10minutes, then transfer to a cooling rack to cool completely.

Tips:

- Cooling on the sheet lets the bottom finish baking gently.

Shopping List

18 items • Total: \$100.42

☐ **113 g Unsalted butter (80% fat, Challenge Dairy cubes)**
\$4.46 • Grocery store – dairy aisle (premium butter cubes)
Substitutes: Regular unsalted butter

☐ **23 g Ice water**
\$0.00 • Home tap water, frozen then measured
Substitutes: Cold filtered water

☐ **170 g Allpurpose flour**
\$3.72 • Grocery store – baking aisle
Substitutes: Bread flour (but texture changes)

☐ **90 g Bread flour**
\$7.87 • Grocery store – baking aisle
Substitutes: All purpose flour

☐ **50 g Spelt flour**
\$11.00 • Health food store or specialty aisle
Substitutes: Whole wheat flour, additional all purpose flour

☐ **1 tsp Baking soda**
\$7.82 • Grocery store – baking aisle
Substitutes: Baking powder (use 3× amount)

☐ **2 tsp Kosher salt**
\$3.82 • Grocery store – spice aisle
Substitutes: Sea salt

☐ **1.5 tsp Cornstarch**
\$2.03 • Grocery store – baking aisle
Substitutes: Arrowroot powder

☐ **1 tsp Finely ground hazelnut coffee**
\$6.59 • Specialty coffee shop or online
Substitutes: Espresso powder, instant coffee (less intense)

☐ **200 g Dark brown sugar**
\$2.33 • Grocery store – baking aisle
Substitutes: Light brown sugar (less molasses)

☐ **175 g Granulated white sugar**
\$3.07 • Grocery store – baking aisle
Substitutes: Caster sugar

☐ **2 Large eggs**
\$0.40 • Grocery store – dairy aisle
Substitutes: Egg substitute (1 egg = 1/4 cup liquid)

☐ **1 Egg yolk**
\$7.99 • Grocery store – dairy aisle
Substitutes: Additional whole egg

☐ **2 tsp Vanilla paste**
\$14.99 • Specialty grocery or online
Substitutes: Vanilla extract (use 1/tsp)

☐ **142 g Semisweet chocolate chips**
\$4.69 • Grocery store – baking aisle
Substitutes: Milk chocolate chips

☐ **142 g Dark chocolate (70% cacao) – chopped**
\$8.15 • Specialty chocolate shop or upscale grocery
Substitutes: Bittersweet chocolate

☐ **142 g White chocolate (for caramelization)**
\$2.50 • Specialty chocolate shop or upscale grocery
Substitutes: Milk chocolate (different flavor)

☐ **1 tsp Flaky finishing salt**
\$8.99 • Grocery store – spice aisle
Substitutes: Sea salt flakes

EQUIPMENT CHECKLIST

- ☒ Kitchen scale
- ☒ Stand mixer with paddle attachment
- ☒ Saucepan (2inch diameter)
- ☒ Baking sheet (rimmed)
- ☒ Parchment paper
- ☒ Food processor
- ☒ Spatula
- ☒ Mixing bowls (medium & large)
- ☒ Measuring spoons
- ☒ Cooling rack
- ☒ Oven
- ☒ Refrigerator

OPTIONAL

CHEF TIPS

- After the 3 day chill, let the dough sit at room temperature for 15/minutes before scooping; this makes shaping easier.
- For extra crunch, sprinkle a pinch of flaky sea salt on each cookie right after removing from the oven.
- If you prefer a chewier center, bake the cookies for the lower end of the time range (12/minutes).

STORAGE INFORMATION

Refrigerator

Store in an airtight container for up to 5/days.

Freezer

Freeze dough balls (pre scooped) for up to 3/months; thaw overnight in fridge before baking.

NUTRITION (PER SERVING)

Calories: 502 • Protein: 2.3/g• Carbs: 53/g• Fat: 28.7/g